Young Candidates Who Rent Want to Make Homes Cheaper

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Homes and apartments in the United States cost a lot. Many young adults still rent with roommates in their thirties, and saving for a first home can feel almost impossible. Now, some young people running for office say living with this problem gives them energy to fix it.

In Connecticut, Olaleye Onikuyide, 28, is running for state representative. He lives with his parents to save money and rides public transit. He wants more **mixed-income housing** and cities where people can walk.

Also in Connecticut, in New Haven, Eli Sabin, 26, rents his home, like about 70% of people in his city. As a college sophomore he served on the city council, which changed **zoning rules** to allow more building. He wants stronger protections against **eviction** and an easier way to buy a first home.

In Montana, Lukas Schubert is only 21 and is campaigning for reelection. He wants more small starter homes. He proposed a **tax break** for builders who sell such homes below the local **median price**. It did not pass, but he plans to try again.

Word Treasure

mixed-income housing -- Mixed-income housing is homes for people who earn different amounts of money in the same area.

zoning rules -- Zoning rules are rules that say what kinds of buildings can be built in each part of a city.

eviction -- Eviction is being forced to leave a home that you rent.

tax break -- A tax break is a cut in taxes meant to encourage people to do something.

median price -- The median price is the middle price, with half of homes costing more and half costing less.

Background you need

People who rent pay money each month to live in a home that belongs to someone else.

In many places in the United States, rents and home prices have grown so high that young adults struggle to save for a first home.

Some young people are now running for office because they live with this problem themselves and want to change the rules about housing.

Break it down

WHO: Young candidates Olaleye Onikuyide, Eli Sabin, and Lukas Schubert
WHAT: They are running for office and pushing ideas to make homes and apartments cheaper
WHERE: In Connecticut and Montana in the United States
WHY: Homes cost a lot, and because they rent or live with family themselves, they say living with the problem gives them energy to fix it

Why it matters

The cost of homes affects where your family can live and whether young adults can one day afford a home of their own.

Test what you remember

1. Why do some young candidates say living with high housing costs gives them energy?

- (A) Because they dislike renting
- (B) Because they own many homes
- (C) Because they live with the problem themselves
- (D) Because they want to move away

2. Where does Olaleye Onikuyide live to save money?

- (A) With roommates
- (B) Alone in an apartment
- (C) With his parents
- (D) In a small starter home

3. What does Eli Sabin want stronger protections against?

- (A) Eviction
- (B) Public transit
- (C) Zoning rules
- (D) Higher taxes

4. What did Eli Sabin serve on as a college sophomore?

- (A) A builders' group
- (B) A school team
- (C) A housing company
- (D) The city council

5. What kind of homes does Lukas Schubert want more of?

- (A) Homes below the water
- (B) Small starter homes
- (C) Homes with roommates
- (D) Bigger family houses

6. What did Lukas Schubert propose for builders?

- (A) Free homes for candidates
- (B) A tax break for builders who sell starter homes below the local median price
- (C) A rule to stop all building
- (D) A prize for the biggest home

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Olaleye Onikuyide: He wants more mixed-income housing and cities where people can walk.

2. Eli Sabin: He wants stronger protections against eviction and an easier way to buy a first home.

3. Lukas Schubert: He wants more small starter homes and proposed a tax break for builders who sell such homes below the local median price, and he plans to try again after it did not pass.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):